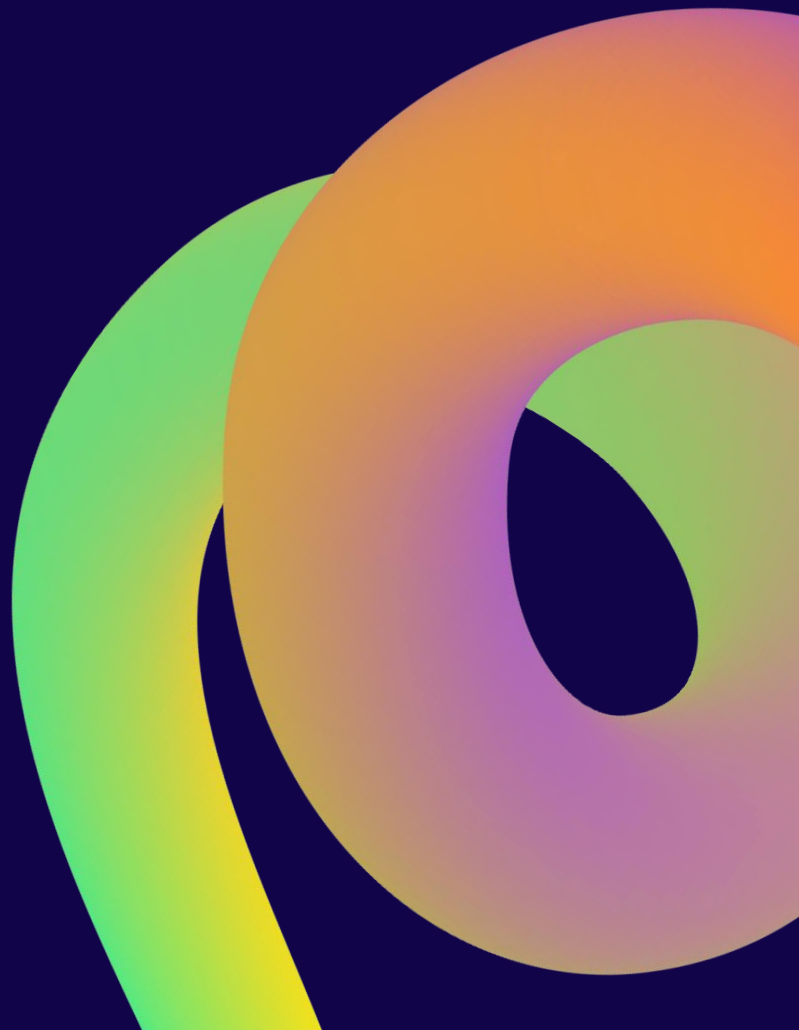
AI;BDR (AI;Because I Didn’t Read) Uncomfortable Conversations About AI

Panel discussion

Kevin Feasel, Jonathan Stewart and Kellyn Gorman

PASS Data Community Summit 2026

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Host redgate



Kevin Feasel



Proprietor
Catallaxy Services, LLC

Kevin is a Microsoft Data Platform MVP who works on data analytics, Spark, Kafka and machine learning. He wrote *PolyBase Revealed* and *Finding Ghosts in Your Data*, runs the Curated SQL blog, and leads the Triangle Area SQL Server Users Group. He has been a CTO and an engineering manager, and these days he helps organizations solve their hardest data problems.

Jonathan Stewart



Founder | Data & AI Architect

Decision Advantage LLC

Jonathan Stewart is the founder of Decision Advantage LLC and a data and AI architect with more than 25 years of enterprise technology experience. He advises executives on data strategy, governance, and the connection between technology investments and business decisions. His technical work spans Azure and Microsoft Fabric architecture. A frequent conference speaker, Jonathan brings both hands-on platform experience and an executive advisory perspective to discussions about data and AI.

Kellyn Gorman



Engineer & Advocate
Redgate

Multi-platform database specialist with over 30 years experience working across Oracle, SQL Server, PostgreSQL and the cloud, focused on AI, observability and running database systems well. Kellyn blogs at dbakevlar.com.

How this lunch panel works

AI is being pulled into the data layer faster than many would like.

Let’s have a real discussion on AI!



- **Ask questions any time, not only at the end**
- **Short answers: two minutes each, then pass it on**
- **Disagreement is welcome, respect is required…well, you don’t have to be polite to any AI. ☺**

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What we're going to be fearless about

Six conversations, no BS…☺

- AI replacing the data professional? 01
- Garbage in, confident garbage out 02
- What are we really sharing with AI? 03
- Should there always be a human in the loop? 04
- Hype versus reality 05
- Predict the future? 06

01 Will AI replace the data professional?

Thoughts on AI replacing data professionals?

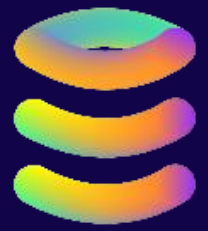
If AI does the junior work, where do the seniors of 2035 come from?

What would you tell someone starting a data career right now?



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02 Garbage in, confident garbage out



Thoughts on vibe coding….your own and then other's vibe coding?

If a model is right 95% of the time, who decided the 5% was acceptable?

We never got data quality right in the first place. How does this impact AI?

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03 What are we really sending to the model?



Hands up: How much PII do you think is being shared? How much unauthorized data?

MCP servers and connectors: who reviewed what the model can reach?

Is your customers' data in a model right now without their knowledge?

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04 Should an agent ever touch production?



Would you give an agent the access you'd give a new hire on day one?

Are we building real guardrails, or just making it look safe on paper?

Autonomy and AI – thoughts?

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05 Hype versus reality

Is your company doing AI because it’s useful, or because the board asked?

What real penalties should be in place when AI is done poorly and at the cost of the user/customer, etc.?

Tokens, GPUs and data centers: is it a real problem?



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06 Predict the Future?

Any predictions for the next 1-2 years?

Thoughts on the AI bubble – will it pop or just lose air slowly?

Do you think leadership and media understand the risk, the threat and the reality of AI or is it a lost cause?



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Lightning round

Agree or disagree, 30 seconds each

- Every Data Professional should be running a local model
- I’d trust AI-generated SQL in production without review
- Most companies’ AI strategy is a press release
- Junior DBA roles won’t exist in five years
- The DBA who refuses to use AI will be unemployable

“What is the AI topic that is the most uncomfortable for you?”

Your turn: audience Q&A

Your feedback is important to us



Evaluate this session at:

passdatacommunitysummit.com/evaluations

Thank you

Thanks for being fearless with us. Find the panel after the session to keep the conversation going.

The panel

- **Kevin Feasel, Company/website**
- **Jonathan Stewart, Company/website**
- **Kellyn Gorman, Redgate, dbakevlar.com**

